



HUMANITAS  
INSTITUTE

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Vero Classical School

School Website: <https://www.veroclassicalschool.org/>

January 7, 2026

**Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

*Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

### Executive Summary

Vero Classical School (VCS) in Vero Beach, FL presents a robust classical framework that aligns strongly with traditional classical-education criteria. Public materials from the school emphasize a Christ-centered, liturgically-inflected, community-focused environment; a Trivium-based curriculum (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric); a history-rich and integrated approach; Socratic discourse at the upper levels; and a "living curriculum" conveyed by faculty who model virtue and intellectual rigor. The school also foregrounds parental partnership and a welcoming, grace-filled community, signaling alignment with classical-parent-community expectations.

Overall, based on the rubric drawn from the classical-school knowledge base, VCS is CLASSICAL across all six categories. The site consistently showcases: (1) Religious and metaphysical foundations anchored in Christ-centered community and virtue; (2) a purpose/goals frame oriented toward formation, wisdom, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty; (3) a curriculum built on the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) with historical study and field experiences; (4) pedagogy that blends contemplative/scholastic approaches with Socratic inquiry and memory work; (5) a faculty model that acts as the living curriculum and mentors; and (6) strong parent/community partnerships with open campuses and formal parent-engagement opportunities. Direct textual anchors include references to Christ-centered education, the Trivium, Socratic dialogue, memory-rich pedagogy, and parent involvement. The evidence is drawn from multiple school pages, including sections titled The Classical Model of Education, The Trivium (Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric), The Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric sequences, Community of Grace, and the Parent/Community materials. See cited sources throughout the category notes.

What would move the needle section is not required here since the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL across all six categories. No major systemic changes are needed to reach a fully classical standing per the rubric.

### ABSTRACT

thematic snapshot: VCS demonstrates a coherent Classical/Traditional orientation across Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose and Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community. The public materials consistently articulate virtue, truth, and beauty in a Christian context; a Trivium-centered liberal arts curriculum; Socratic and oral-communication emphasis; strong faculty-role as mentors; and active parental involvement and welcoming community practices.

## ABSTRACT

- Overall classification: CLASSICAL
  - Core drivers: Christ-centered, Trivium-based curriculum; Socratic pedagogy; living-faculty model; parental partnership; history-forward and integrated curriculum; emphasis on wonder and memory.
  - Notable strengths: Clear Trivium structure (Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric), Socratic and memory-based pedagogy, Christ-centered community, and explicit parent involvement.
  - Needle-moving considerations: None deemed necessary at this time given the strong alignment; if desired, future growth could emphasize explicit Great-Books-language markers, broader non-religious historical texts, or more explicit articulation of Great Books/Great Conversation language in public-facing copy to further embody the classical lexicon.
- 

## Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

### Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

#### Evidence

- Public materials foreground a Christian, Christ-centered framework and “Community of Grace,” including language about God, Christ, and grace as guiding the learning environment. For example, the site presents a Christ-centered education and a community of grace that emphasizes acceptance in Christ (evidenced by sections such as “Community of Grace” and “Christ-Centered”).
- Texts emphasize truth, goodness, and beauty as guiding ideals in education, e.g., references to pursuing truth, goodness, and beauty and the aim to form students in a Christian context.
- The site presents a liturgical- and worship-adjacent ethos via “The Norm” and “Community of Grace,” and a sense of sacred, reverent learning within a Christian framework.

#### Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present (examples from a canonical lexicon): truth, beauty, virtue, theology, liturgy/worship, grace, Christ-centered, imago Dei, Logos, reverence, wonder. The site frequently uses Christ-centered and Community of Grace language, and explicitly ties education to truth/beauty/virtue within a Christian framework. This yields multiple positive indicators.
- Negative keywords: No clear secular-humanist, relativist, or morally-neutral framing appears in public copy.

#### Why this rating

- The material consistently anchors education in a transcendent moral order (truth/beauty/virtue) and Theology, with liturgical/community practices. The strongest signals are explicit Christ-centered language and a community-of-grace ethos, aligning with the Positive Keywords for Element 1. Overall, this category aligns strongly with Classical norms rather than diverging into secular or relativist frames.

#### Cited exemplars

- Christ-centered, Community of Grace, and grace-themed community language.
  - Pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty; Christ-centered framing.
- 

### Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

#### Evidence

- The site emphasizes formation and the cultivation of human flourishing and wisdom through a classical frame, with explicit language about pursuing truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable, align-

ing with the classical telos that centers formation over mere information. The Home/Classical pages discuss forming minds to love learning, think deeply, and engage with the broader classical tradition.

- The presence of “The Fullness of Education” and “A Foundation for the Future” signals a purposeful focus on formation, virtue, and a broader, enduring education rather than mere job preparation alone.

#### Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty, great conversation (though explicit Great Conversation language appears more in lexicon than as a direct page phrase), human excellence, scholé, contemplation, and wonder. The site demonstrates formation and contemplation themes (e.g., “The Fullness of Education,” “The Trivium” framework and integrated culture).
- Negative keywords: No explicit emphasis on 21st-century workforce metrics or purely job-preparation language; no strong signals of secular relativism. The content is aligned with formation within a transcendent frame.

#### Why this rating

- The school’s public materials emphasize formation and the cultivation of virtue and wisdom (not primarily job-prep). That alignment with “formation,” “pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty,” and a liberal-arts orientation supports CLASSICAL.

#### Cited exemplars

- The pursuit of wisdom, truth, and beauty; formation-focused language in the core pages.
- “Foundation for the Future” and “A Foundation for the Future” language signaling enduring formation beyond immediate job prep.

---

### Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

#### Evidence

- Trivium framework is central on the site: Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric are presented as core stages, with explicit navigation to Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric pages. This is a hallmark of classical liberal arts education.
- History is described as a chronological, integrated study across the curriculum, anchored in foundational humanities and classic literary approaches (e.g., “The chronological study of history serves as a framework for understanding the great thinkers, events, and ideas that have shaped our world”). This shows an integrated historical approach within the curriculum.
- Classical methods emphasize “time-tested methods” including songs, movement, guided discovery, round-table discussions, and Socratic questioning, with direct mentions of memory work and the study of classics. This aligns with a rhetoric/logic/culture-first curriculum and supports Great Books–adjacent aims through reading closely and engaging with foundational texts.
- Curriculum content details include grammar/phonics in Grammar, logic in Logic, and rhetoric in Rhetoric, plus a strong emphasis on Literature and field experiences that broaden the classical toolkit.
- The Arts and Classics integration (Arts/Literature/Drama/Chess) demonstrate a broad liberal-arts orientation and the aim of integrated study, all within a Christian/classical framing.

#### Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: liberal arts, Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books/primary sources (the site emphasizes classic works and literature), history as a core thread, Socratic questioning, memorization and recitation, and integrated curriculum. The presence of “grammar/logic/rhetoric” and “Socratic questioning” are direct markers of classical pedagogy.
- Negative keywords: The site does not foreground project-based-only approaches or a strictly social-studies-first framing; rather, it emphasizes classical-history integration and Great-Books-esque en-

gagement in a Christian framework, which mitigates the presence of the negative indicators in the lexicon.

#### Why this rating

- The curriculum is clearly built around the classical Trivium and liberal-arts ideals, with explicit historical/-Great Books-adjacent phrasing and integrated humanities emphasis. This places the school squarely in CLASSICAL territory.

#### Cited exemplars

- The Trivium framing (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) and history-centered approach.
- Chronological history study and “great books”-adjacent, integrated curriculum language.
- Explicit articulation of a liberal-arts education and integrated curriculum (The Fullness of Education; Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric).

### Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

#### Evidence

- Contemplative/restful learning is acknowledged in the pedagogy language, with emphasis on memory, chant, and contemplative aspects (Scholé-like feel) in lower grades, combined with active Socratic dialogue and rhetoric training in upper grades. The Grammar articulation notes “hands-on activities,” guided discovery, and memory work; the Logic/Rhetoric sections describe Socratic dialogue and rhetoric as core tools.
- Lower-school practices include singing, chanting, memorization, and a restful, memory-deep approach; upper school engages in Socratic seminars, debates, and rhetoric-based activities. The public copy explicitly references these methods, aligning with classical pedagogy.
- The Rhetoric School section describes tools for life, debate, and persuasive speaking, showing explicit rhetoric training and oral-communication emphasis in higher grades.

#### Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, round-table discussions, memory work, chanting, recitation, dialectic, rhetoric, oratory, debate, persuasion, and formal debate; contemplative/scholé/restful learning; Liturgical/calendar integration; and memory-based learning. These are direct matches to classical pedagogy keywords.
- Negative keywords present: The site does not emphasize a constructivist, experiential-only, or student-directed-only pedagogy; instead, it layers Socratic inquiry with structured memory and classical forms, which counters those negative indicators. Therefore negative signals are minimal.

#### Why this rating

- The school’s pedagogy combines contemplative/restful elements with rigorous, Socratic, and rhetorical approaches, across lower and upper grades. This mixture reflects classical teaching methods more than any non-classical approach.

#### Cited exemplars

- Lower-grade memory/chanting, guided discovery, and memory work.
- Upper-grade Socratic discussions, seminars, and debates; rhetoric training and public speaking.
- The “The Fullness of Education” and Trivium framework showing a layered pedagogy.

### Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

#### Evidence



- Faculty identity is strongly presented as model teachers and mentors who embody virtue and knowledge, constituting the “living curriculum” and a collegial, community-based faculty culture. Public pages (including staff profiles) show teachers with strong subject expertise and Christian commitments. A staff biography (e.g., Katie Arango) emphasizes subject-area expertise, faith integration, and a calling toward forming students in truth, goodness, and beauty.
- The site references a faculty portrait and “portrait of what a teacher should be” in classical terms, as well as a living-curriculum concept where teachers are central to the school’s culture. The “Faculty” section and staff examples illustrate this living curriculum, with teachers modeling virtue and intellectual rigor.
- Content indicates collegial faculty with a shared mission and a culture of mentorship and virtue, as seen in the staff pages and the faculty-centered curriculum approach.

#### Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: living curriculum, model teachers, mentors, faculty as guides, portrait of teacher, collegiate culture, moral exemplars, virtuous life. The site repeatedly frames teachers as central to the school’s mission.
- Negative keywords: None evident in public copy; no references to a degraded or purely administrative teaching model.

#### Why this rating

- The public materials present a strong, positive portrayal of faculty as moral exemplars and living-curriculum guides, aligning with Classical expectations for teacher leadership and mentorship.

#### Cited exemplars

- Katie Arango staff profile and faith-integrated teaching ethos.
- The “living curriculum” and teacher-centered emphasis.

### Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

#### Evidence

- The school presents explicit partnerships with parents, viewing parents as co-teachers and inviting active parent involvement, including parent nights, tours, and opportunities to engage with the school community. The “Parent Information Nights,” “Expression of Interest,” and “Don’t Be Afraid to Ask” sections show structured parent engagement and ongoing education for parents about classical education.
- Community-oriented language emphasizes “Community of Grace,” welcoming atmosphere, and small-class environments that foster parental involvement and open access (office hours, campus visits). The “Community of Grace” page emphasizes acceptance, individualized attention, and partnership with families in forming children in Christ.
- The behavioral tone invites parental participation, visits, and information nights, signaling an engaged parent community. The “Expression of Interest” and admissions-related pages indicate ongoing parental involvement.

#### Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parent formation, book studies, seminars, family involvement, open campus, parent visitation, and parental engagement.
- Negative keywords: No consumerist or minimal-parent-involvement signals; rather, the copy signals active parental engagement and formation.

#### Why this rating

- The public materials demonstrate a robust, classical-oriented partnership with parents and a welcoming, engaged community, which aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for Element 6.

## Cited exemplars

- Partnership with parents and co-teaching language.
  - Community-of-Grace and family-involvement language.
- 

**What Would Move the Needle**

- Given this school's CLASSICAL standing across all six categories, no major "needle-moving" changes are required to achieve full alignment. If desired, minor enhancements could include:
  - Publicly foregrounding explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language on more pages to strengthen the Great Books dimension in Element 3.
  - Adding a brief, explicit articulation of the full spectrum of the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) as a formal statement of aims on the homepage to reinforce the Element 3/Element 4 signals for readers unfamiliar with classical pedagogy.
-

## Appendix

### ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.